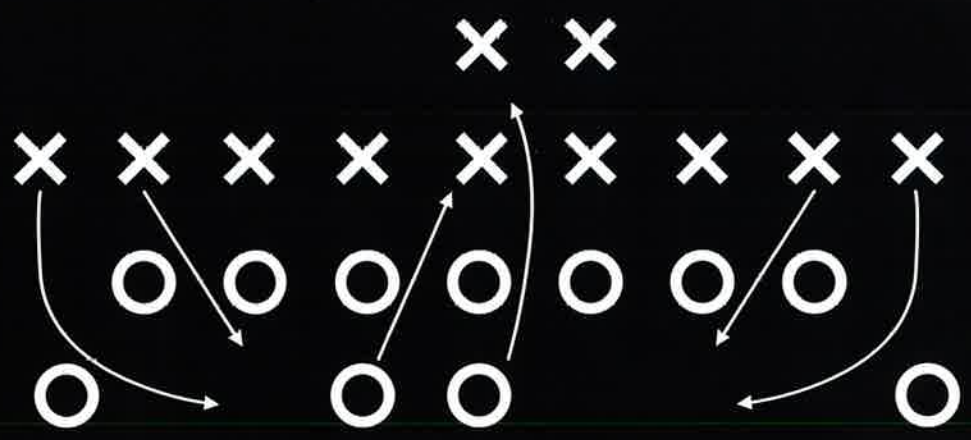
PRIVATE COLLECTION

$100M PLAYBOOK: GOATed ADS



ALEX HORMOZI

HOW TO MAKE ADS THAT GET THE **RIGHT PEOPLE** TO ***CLICK***

ACQUISITION.COM

$100M Playbook: GOATed Ads

How to Make Ads That Get the Right People to Click

ALEX HORMOZI

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GOATed Ads

Winning Ads in Under 30 mins.

Disclaimer: This is to be used on top of the paid ads chapters in *$100M Leads*. Not instead of. This takes those ideas and puts them on steroids.

Summer 2020 - December 2021

"Why don't you scale your ads?" I asked one of our portfolio founders.

"Every time we try, we hit a wall. We've just saturated this market."

"Bro you sell weight loss on Facebook and spend $200,000 per month on ads."

"Yea, but it's the only thing that can explain it. After about 5–8k per day in ad spend, our cost to acquire customers shoots through the roof."

"How often are you recording new ads?

"At least once a month."

"Wait. You're only making ads once a month?"

"Yea… at least!"

"How many new ads do you get?"

"At least five, sometimes a few more."

"I figured out the problem."

"What? Really?"

"Yeah, you're gonna take *at least five* and change it to *at least 500.*"

He looked too shocked to say much, so I kept going.

"Okay, here's the plan. You're gonna devote every single Friday to advertising. First, find your best ads. Second, chop them into: hook, meat, Call-To-Action (CTA). Then we'll try and find 50 new variations of each to make 50 more hooks and with it, generate three to five variations on the meat. If we do that, we'll be making 150 ads per week. That means we'll go from five ads a month to 600 ads a month."

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"That's a ton…"

"Yeah, your business won't get smaller," I continued.

"You haven't saturated Facebook. But you have gotten all the low hanging fruit. You've hit a wall with your ad quality, not with the market. The better your ads, the bigger the audience they'll convert."

"Yea, I guess that makes sense."

"Remember those Old Spice ads with the dude on the horse?"

"Yea those were great."

"Right. I wasn't an Old Spice buyer. I saw those ads and thought they were funny then started buying their stuff. And so did 70% of the market. That's an ad that wasn't capped. It was good enough to convert *everyone*. That's how you make ads that scale—you make better ads. And you only do that by making more… *way more*."

***

The company doubled in two quarters. It's how we run ads for Acquisition.com, Skool.com, and all of our other companies running paid ads.

And this isn't some fancy idea that *might* work. This process took me 13 years to develop. Simply put, it works.

Outline

This playbook has three main sections.

First, I'm going to briefly explain why most people's ads hit a ceiling and how to scale past it.

Second, I'm going to explain the ad creation process I use.

Third, I'll explain the types of ads I use—which give you endless buckets of creative.

Armed with the knowledge from all three sections, you'll be able to create "banger after banger" and pummel your competition. Let's make some money.

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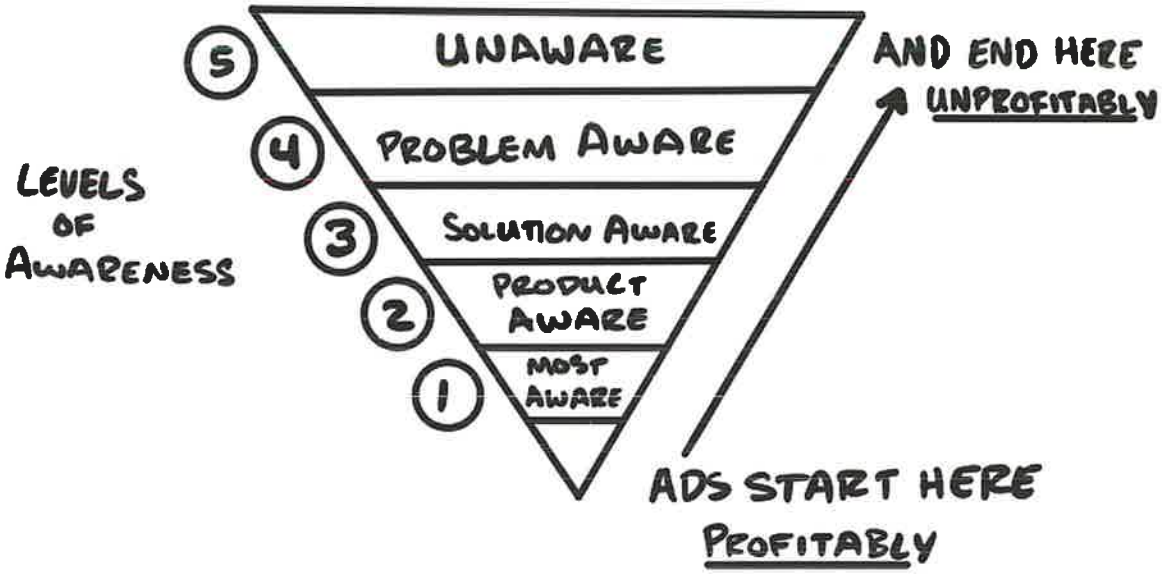
Why Ads Hit A Wall And How To Scale Past It



In the beginning, you start with the smallest but highest converting eyeballs. Then, as you scale, you go to progressively larger but lower-converting eyeballs. Eugene Schwartz has a wonderful framework around this. He contends that audiences go from bottom (warmest and smallest) to top (coldest and largest) in alignment with the image above:

1) Most Aware (bottom): The customer knows your product and only needs to know the deal.

2) Product-Aware: The customer knows what you sell but isn't sure it's right for them.

3) Solution-Aware: The customer knows the result they want but doesn't know your product can provide it.

4) Problem-Aware: The customer senses they have a problem but doesn't know there's a solution.

5) Completely Unaware (top): The customer doesn't know they have a problem or need.

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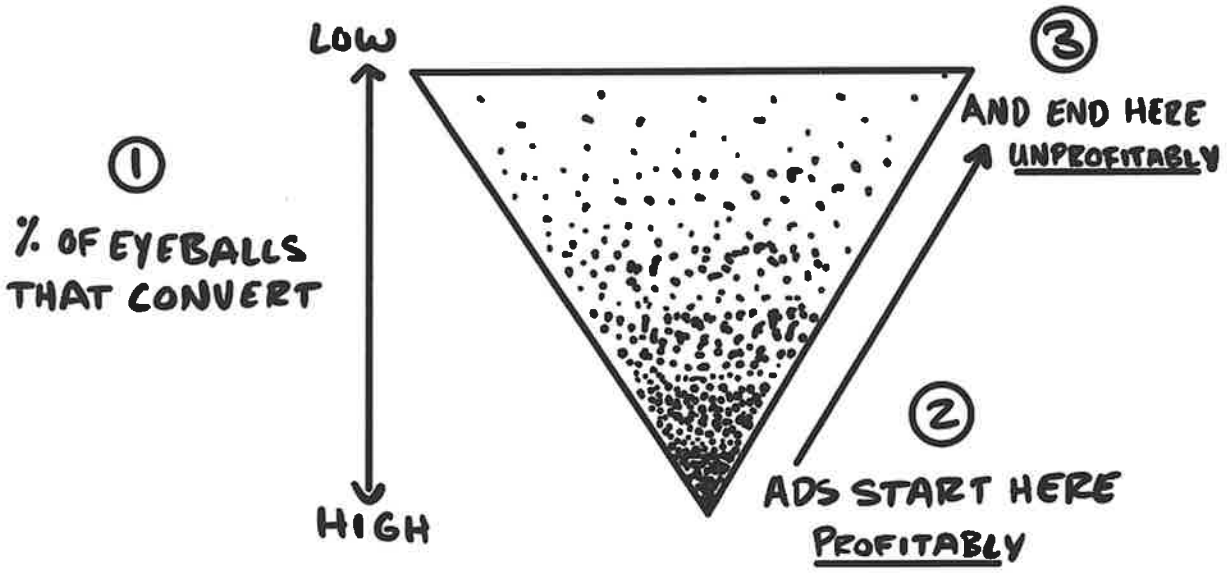
I want to be clear, I've never met these people in Eugene's pyramid. Labels are clean. Reality is messy. All I know is that the larger the audience I reach, the more varied and exceptional my ads must be. And for that reason I've adapted his chunked model into a continuous one. I find thinking about it like this to be more useful for actual business owners. I visualize it like this.



Ads start profitably, then depending on how good the creative is (how strong the hook, the offer, and the person delivering it), the colder the traffic it can convert. The higher up the pyramid it can scale. That being said, easier said than done. And this playbook isn't about theory, it's about doing. So, if we want to scale our ads, we want to make ads that convert the highest percentage of the largest audience possible. And in my experience, we need to have a process that consistently creates bangers. Thankfully, we have just that.

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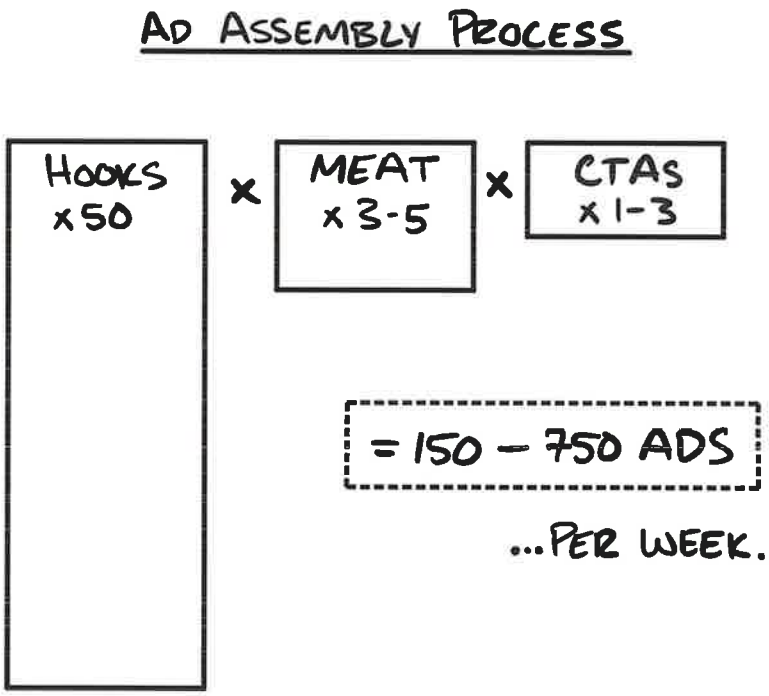
The Ad Assembly Process



As I began to mass produce ads, I realized it was much harder to make a bunch of ads at once and much easier to make the ads in *parts.* So, over time I began "chunking" ad creation into an assembly line-like process. First, I would make fifty hooks. Then, I would record the three to five very well thought-out scripts to match the hooks, and then I would have my one to three versions of my Call To Action or CTA.

As I began making ads this way, my ads began winning more often. And, I realized I wasn't really *creating* ads at all. I was *assembling* them.

It only takes an hour or two to make the hooks, maybe an hour to record three to five "meats" and five minutes to record a few CTAs. The rest of the time is dedicated to prep. But, the result of this prep is 50 hooks x 3-5 meat x 1-3 CTAs = 150 to 750 ads… *per week*. This is how you scale advertising. It also gives you the side benefit of no one being able to figure out your top performing ads. So not only is this a good offense, it's also a good defense against copycats.

So let's dive into each chunk so you know what to do before your next recording session.

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Next Time You film

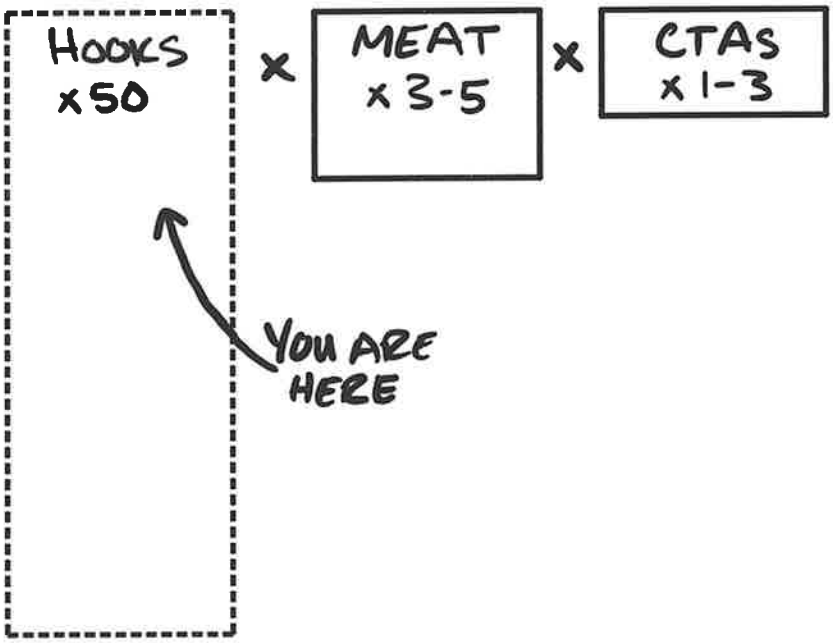
Six-Pack-Abs are made in the kitchen, not in the gym. And like six-packs, ads are made in research, *not* in recording. In other words, 90% of the work in advertising is in the preparation to record, not in the recording itself. Here's how I split my prep time:

- 80% Hooks
- 20% Meat
- ~0% CTAs

And this follows because if someone doesn't make it through the hook, then nothing else matters. So we put 80% of our time there.

I break up hook writing into two chunks. First, I write hooks off my previous winners. These are the bread-and-butter ads that you make on a weekly basis. Then, I write experimental hooks to expand my ads into new markets. I explain both in detail below.

Writing Hooks For Immediate Results From Previous Winners



First, this isn't my Hooks Playbook. In there, I go over the types of words to use, along with a list of my all-time best hooks for content, emails, tweets, and paid ads. Instead, this section focuses on how I find hooks to make high-converting advertisements. I look for high-converting hooks in the following places:

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1) **Winning Hooks From Your Previous Ads** - These are literally past winners that I reuse. Over time you'll develop a stable of winners you can use and reuse. You'd be amazed how much runway one good hook can give you. Note: If it's your first time running ads, skip this one.

2) **Winning Hooks From Your Free Content** - One of my favorite things to do is find hooks that work on one platform or advertising method and use it in another. These have the highest likelihood of converting. I grab these from longs, shorts, tweets, emails, etc. That means I look at content that performed well, and see if I can chop the hook off the front and use it in an ad that may or may not be related to the content it came from originally.

3) **Winning Hooks From Other People's Ads** - I save all ads I like and write down the hooks they use. If they are broad enough, and can be used as a hook for my ads, I use them. I have an album on my phone where I save them all.

4) **Winning Hooks From Other People's Free Content** - You just look for content with tons of views in your space. Snag the hook and give it a shot.

5) **Platform-Specific Ad Libraries** - I list this last because it's the last place I look. Pros: You can see a bajillion ads from any business you want. Cons: You'll have a hard time figuring out which ads perform well enough to justify modeling. Remember, most people don't know what they're doing. Big ad libraries become a fun place for ideas more than they guarantee winners. So if I'm looking for inspiration, I'll look at companies I know run great paid ads, and see what hooks they are using. Key point: Winning hooks in one industry often work in others.

Once you get ads converting, it's *far more* about doing more/better than about doing something new. But if you do need something new, especially to reach a broader audience, then you need to write *expansion hooks*.

Writing Expansion Hooks To Enter New Markets

Let's say you've "capped" your existing ad capacity. You can't spend any more money profitably. You likely need to refresh your creative. But let's say you've done that too. If that's the case, then you may need to expand the audience you target with your hooks.

Here's how: If you continue to write hooks that focus on your offer or proof, you will convert a small slice of a larger audience very well. To grab a bigger slice of the pie you'll want to *meet the audience where they're at*. Here are some example ad hooks that resonate for each level of awareness.

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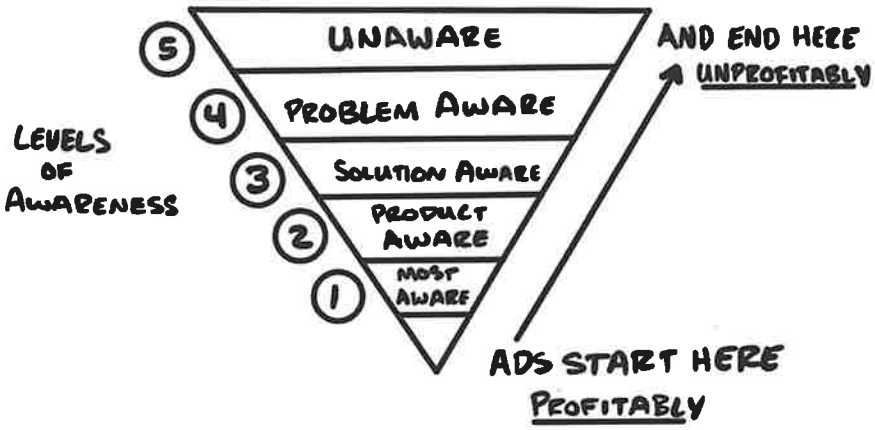

1) **Most Aware:** These hooks are typically offer-driven.
    a) "50% off our best-selling XYZ product for the rest of the month."
    b) Explanation: This hook targets customers who already know the business and its products/services. It focuses on a specific offer with a clear incentive. The goal is to get people on the fence to take action.
2) **Product-Aware:** These hooks are typically proof-driven.
    a) "Discover why 10,000 people chose XYZ to solve their [problem] last month."
    b) Explanation: This hook is for people who know about the product you sell but don't yet know that *you* sell it. It uses specific results and breadth of experience to build fast credibility and differentiate.
3) **Solution-Aware:** These ads are typically promise-driven.
    a) "The fastest way to [achieve desired result] - introducing XYZ."
    b) Explanation: This hook is for customers who are aware of the problem and know that solutions exist, but they may not know about your specific product or how it compares to others. They're familiar with the general types of solutions available but haven't decided on a particular one. At this level, you'd focus your messaging on introducing solutions. You offer a specific, big outcome fast. You can also add specificity to the promise and timeframe to make it more compelling.
4) **Problem-Aware:** These ads are typically pain-driven.
    a) "Tired of [specific problem]? There's a better way."
    b) Explanation: At this level, the potential customer knows they have a problem

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or need, but they're not yet aware of the solutions available. They might be actively searching for ways to solve their issue, but they don't know about specific products or services that could help them.

5) **Completely Unaware:** These ads are typically curiosity-driven.

   a) "The hidden danger in your daily routine that's costing you [money/time/health]."

   b) Explanation: This hook targets people unaware they have a problem. It creates curiosity by suggesting there's an *unknown issue costing them*. The goal is to make them curious and lead them down the road to becoming aware of their problem. This gets them thinking about solutions they didn't know they needed until now.

Now that we have these templates, let's translate them into business-to-business (B2B) examples and business-to-consumer (B2C) examples. Let's start a weight loss shake called XFast as our business-to-consumer example:

1) **Most Aware:** *"XFast's new formula: Now with 25% more protein - Same great taste!"*

2) **Product-Aware:** *"Why 9 out of 10 XFast users reached their goal weight within 3 months."*

3) **Solution-Aware:** *"Lose 15 pounds in 30 days with our scientifically proven meal replacement system."*

4) **Problem-Aware:** *"Frustrated with crash diets that don't last? There's a sustainable way to shed pounds."*

5) **Completely Unaware:** *"The hidden hormonal imbalance that's making 1 in 3 Americans gain weight."*

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Let me walk you through a business-to-business example for a marketing agency called Digital Boost:

1) **Most Aware:** *"DigitalBoost: Now offering social media management at 20% off for new clients."*
2) **Product-Aware:** *"See how DigitalBoost increased ROI by 150% for 5 different industries."*
3) **Solution-Aware:** *"Double your online sales in 6 months with our data-driven marketing strategies."*
4) **Problem-Aware:** *"Is your website getting sales? You might be missing these crucial elements."*
5) **Completely Unaware:** *"The unexpected way your business is losing $1000s each month in untapped revenue."*

Pro Tip: The Widest Hooks Possible

Memes or meme-like content attract the largest percentage of your audience. If you target a narrower group than everyone else, then they will have their own culture-specific memes you can advertise with in much the same way. A relevant meme for a specific audience works like a moth to a flame. It will explode the number of eyeballs exposed to your ad. Consider testing them. I certainly do.

Hopefully, this is getting your wheels turning in terms of how you start your ads and make your content to appeal to more specific or broader audiences.

That being said, think of these more as frameworks than some magical recipe. You may see a national ad that has a killer offer-driven hook. Like the $5 Foot Long by Subway (which for 20 years ran as a sandwich ad). This only works because the entire nation knows the product. So in a way, they can have an offer-driven hook - *to everyone* - because they've already spent hundreds of millions getting everyone to know who they are already. And, everyone knows what a sandwich is. So they have a known product, and a known brand. So they just need to make an offer. Whereas if you were a no name competitor, and you have a product that people need education to understand, leading

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with an offer-driven hook to a national audience would be the closest thing to setting money on fire. On the other extreme, you might see a broad piece of content that spikes people's curiosity and gets a very warm audience to buy. Like a movie trailer that converts a wide audience that also converts its warm audience of fans. So, this isn't written in stone. This just gives you another set of tools in your arsenal when you're writing down your 50 hooks.

If 90% of your hooks land in the "most aware" bucket, spread them out to capture a bigger slice. When in doubt, go a little broader. You still catch your warm audience *and* attract some of the colder audience too.

I go through my own past winners. Then, I write 50 or so hooks spread across my audience buckets. That's about it. Then, I move into the next chunk of my prep document: *the meat*.

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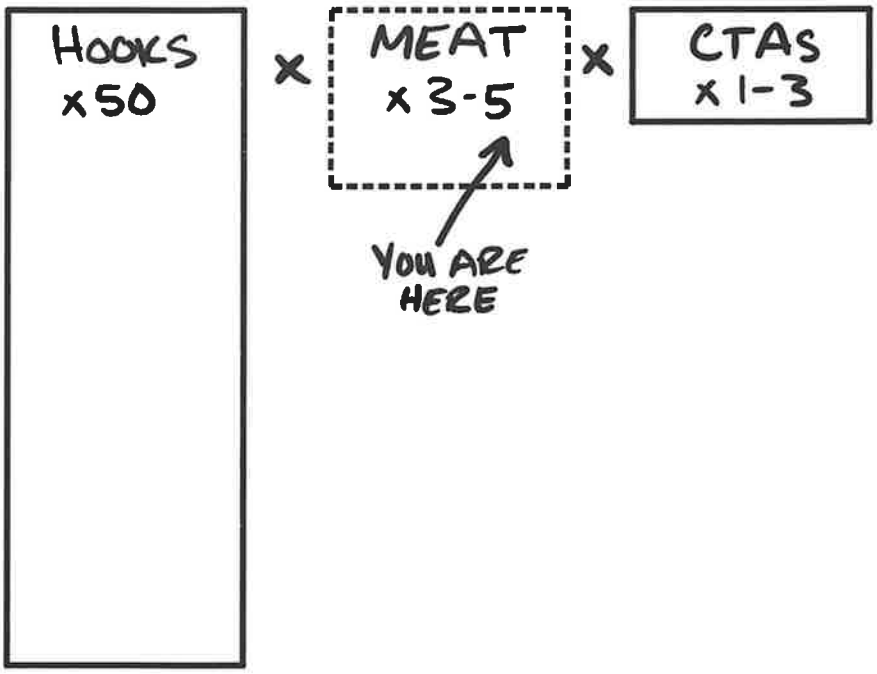
The Ad Meat



Every ad has creative. It's the part of the ad *that fulfills your hook*. The creative aligns with the hook, the hook aligns with the audience's awareness level. This means the creative tends to educate the customer about: the offer, the product, the solution, and the problem, or makes them aware about the phenomenon that is your product to begin with.

As a reminder, the meat only takes 20% of my attention. *The body of an ad gets rotated less often because fewer people see it.* So you don't "use it up" as often. Usually three to five per weekly recording session is more than enough.

When I looked back at all my ads, I used five major formats. No, I'm not saying these are the *only* formats. I'm just saying these are the ones I've used *that worked*. And they've worked across all industries: services, education, physical products, brick and mortar, software, and so on. I also encourage their mixing and matching. Here they are:

1) Demonstration Ads
2) Testimonial ads
3) Education Ads
4) Story Ads
5) Faceless Ads

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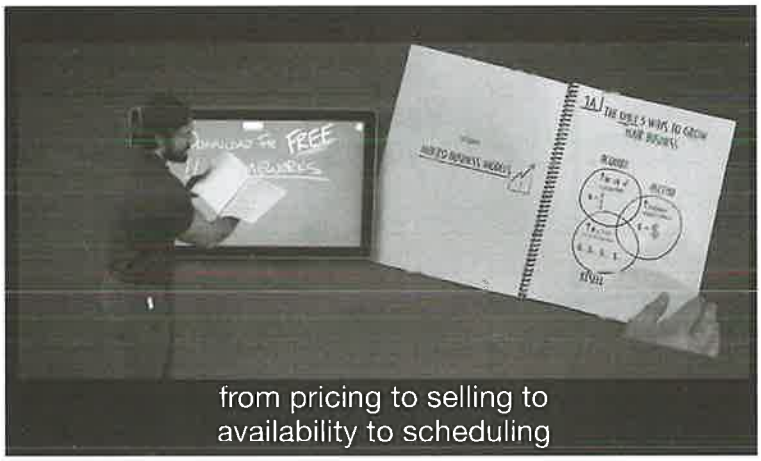
Format #1: Demonstration Ads: Think live use or reactions, unboxing, comparisons (think before-and-afters), high production hero ads (think Dollar Shave Club and Old Spice).

Product Demonstration:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/2478813179002256/



This ad literally shows the lead magnet while explaining it.

High production hero ad #1:

https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1163583621545614

This ad is fast paced, switches scenes and shows the product & results throughout.

High production hero ad #2:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/1089714094862618

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High production hero ad #3:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/138303858068421

Service Demonstration:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/2034958783418395/

This ad shows the results of the service - a packed gym.

Format #2: Testimonial Ads: Think user-generated content, direct-to-camera, podcast style, professional testimonials, raw iPhone style testimonials, walk 'n talk rants, group testimonials with many people in the frame, lifecycle ads (see Marketing Machine Playbook), man-on-the-street interviews, or influencer collabs.

Podcast style:

My team clipped this from a recording session and it ended up becoming one of our top ads for Skool.

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Parade Of Proof Testimonial:

https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=457677610462277

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/187736396037454/

My favorite group testimonial style: A parade of proof.

Another version of a "parade of proof" group testimonial.

Lifecycle ad:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/1092224811300421

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Raw Testimonial:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/433567374641931/

we were making about
$4k a month,

Walk 'n Talk Rant Style:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/1903299683250973/

This is me showing results at an actual location in a casual rant format.

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Format #3: Education Ads: Think explainer videos, how-to listicles, and high-performing organic content.

Whiteboard Explainer ad 1:

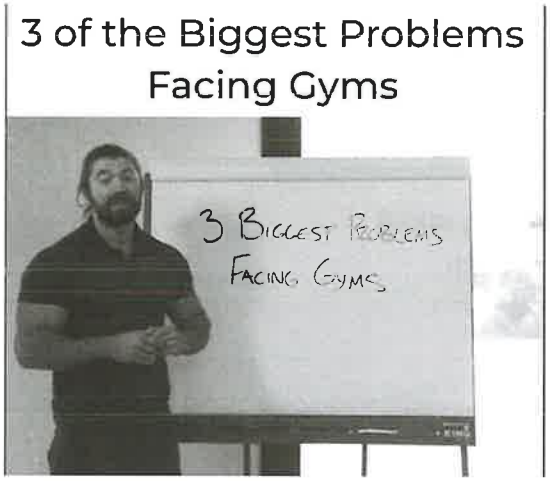
https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/4800528446638878

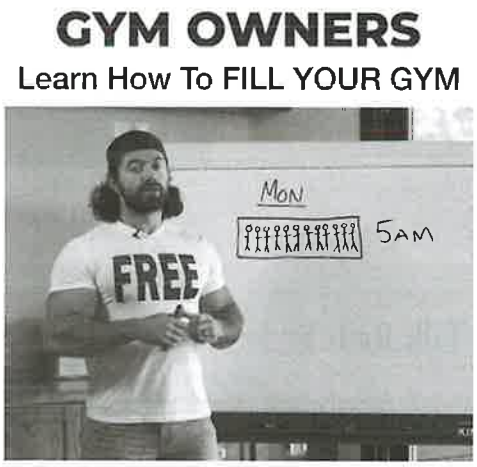
SCAN ME

Whiteboard Explainer ad 2:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/1053288385120213/

SCAN ME





Ad 1 on the left. Ad 2 on the right.

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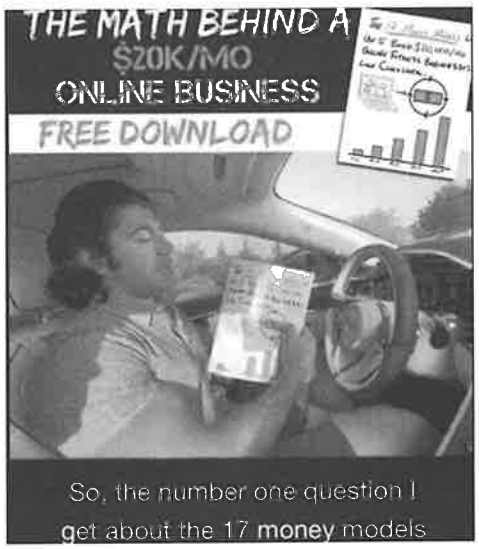
Format #4: Story Ads: Think storytelling, lifestyle, warnings and opportunities, documentary style, skits, and brand manifestos.

Lifestyle ad (I actually hated this, but it performed well):

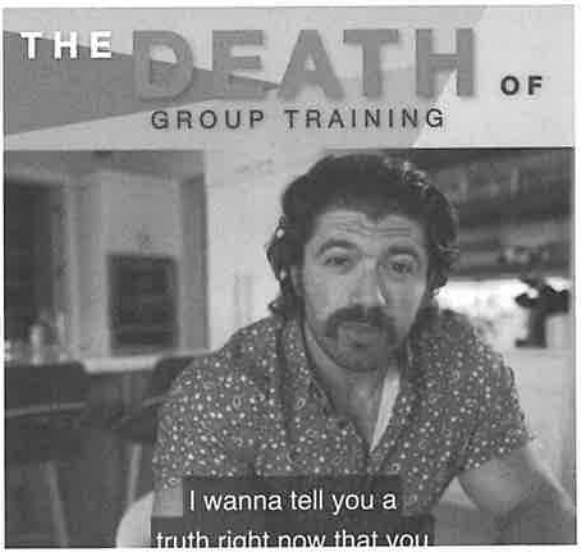
https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/338496783836743/



This is the only ad I ever ran where I flaunted wealth. I returned the car within six months.

Storytelling:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/452712178849593/



This ad slayed.

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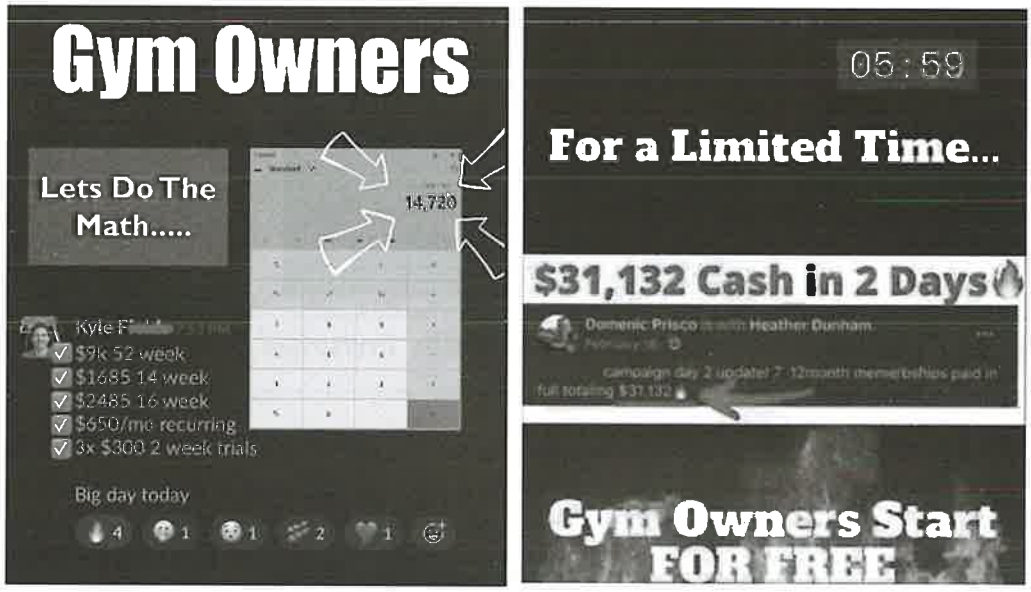
Format #5: Faceless Ads: Think screenshots of customer comments/texts, text only, slide shows, animations, cartoon ads, or visual effect-based ads.

Screenshot compilation ad:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/1132957510464609

Screenshot compilation ad 2:

https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/548127246176341



These are screenshots we ran on their own as ads.

Whenever I get stuck on what type of ad or format I'm going to use for the "meat," I refer back to this list as an easy reference.

So, if you know your hook, and you have your meat, the last thing you need is your CTA.

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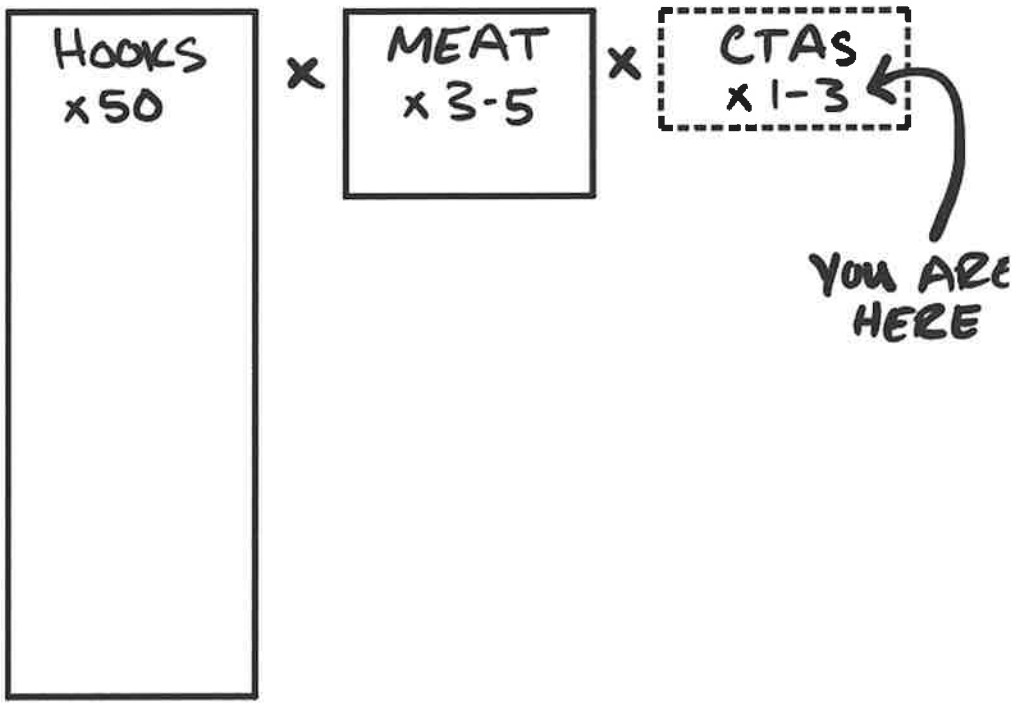
CTA - Call To Action

Clear > Clever



If your ad got them interested, then your audience will have huge motivation… for a tiny time. Take advantage. Tell them *exactly* what to do next. S-P-E-L-L it out: Click this button. Call this number. Reply with "YES". Go to this website. Scan this QR Code (wink). So many ads *still* don't do this. Your audience can only know what to do if you tell them.

If you want to take this up a level *show and tell them*. So not only do you make your CTA quick and easy… *demonstrate* what it would look like for them to follow the next step. *Show* what happens when they click the button. *Show* where they'll need to fill out their information. Actually walk through the next steps and clicking submit on your site, or call your number. This seems obvious and basic, but almost no one does it… *and it really works*.

Now, when they click *and get exactly what they expected*, they'll be more likely to follow through. It provides the ultimate congruence.

Beyond these basics which most still forget, you can also use all the tactics like urgency, scarcity, guarantees, and bonuses. They get even more people to take action. So, they apply here, and everywhere else you tell your audience to do something.

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Make One To Three CTAs Per Recording Session

CTAs come last. Mostly because they have to make sense for the ad, but they also take the least effort to make. But, they still play a critical role in a sound advertisement. If you don't tell anyone to take action, you will have *significantly* fewer people taking action. In other words, *more people will do what you want more often if you tell them to do it.*

So, once I know my offer, I only test a few CTAs. Once you have one that follows the fundamentals it will work well enough. A sound CTA hasn't ever broken a campaign, but *no* CTA has. Here are a few ways you can tell your audience to take the next step.

A good CTA shows or tells: what to do, how to do it, when to do it, what they get for doing it, and what happens next.

Example:

What to do: *Take advantage of this great offer by*

How to do it: *tapping the button on the bottom of your screen…*

When to do it: *….before it expires…*

What they get for doing it: *…and you'll get $1,000 of free stuff.*

What happens next* (optional): *…delivered straight to your inbox.*

This is more important with lead magnets and multi-step sales processes

Demonstration (video): *Show visually what happens at each step.*

Once I have one or two CTAs that work, I mostly stick with them. All you have to do to figure it out is run three identical hook + ad meat combinations, to the same audience, only changing the CTA.

For example, if I am telling people to start a 14-day free trial. I may run three different CTAs at the end of the same ad:

1) "Start free on the next page."
2) "Grab your 14-day free trial on the next page."
3) "Get started on the next page free."

So I spend the least amount of time on CTAs. But once you have a clear one that follows the steps, stick with it.

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Round Out Your CTA By *Showing* What Happens Next

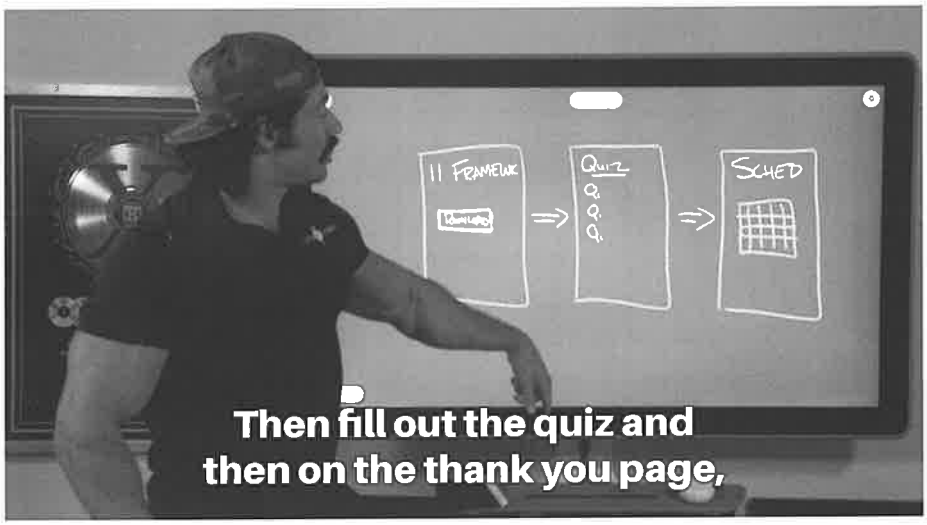
I know all this stuff was easy to say, so let's go through some examples.

1) Showing what happens next: Gym Launch Example.
    a) Full ad: https://www.facebook.com/share/v/VwC93Ln5db9qCoqj/

SCAN ME

    b) The CTA begins at 3:04 and shows *what happens next.*
    c) Here's a screenshot.

Note: If I made this now I would show each screen on my digital board, then swipe through them live. But this ad still worked great.



2) Showing what happens next. Skool Example.
    a) Full ad: https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=502288609151931

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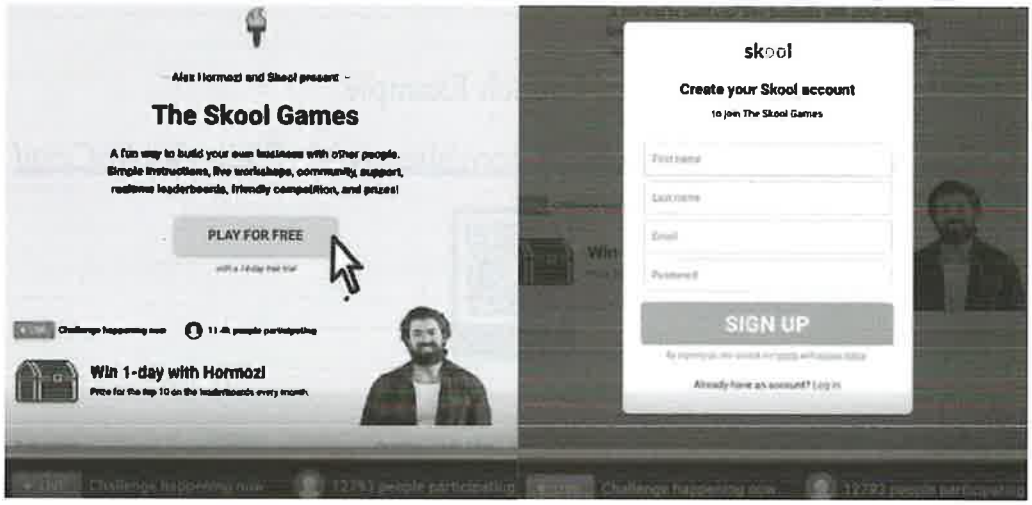
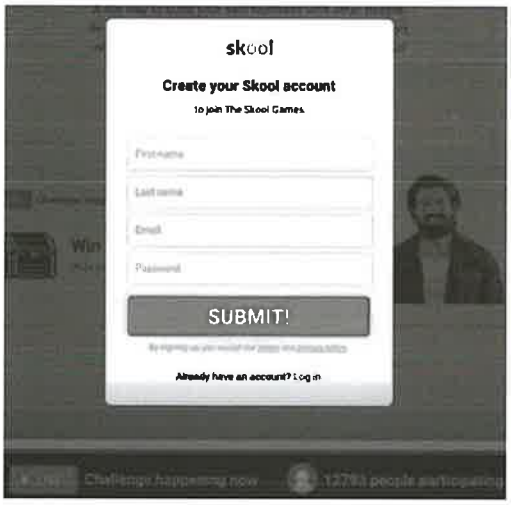
b) The last five seconds include the CTA and *what happens next.*

c) Here's a screenshot





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Bonus: Add Urgency

a) Full ad: https://www.facebook.com/HormoziAlex/videos/1089714094862618

b) This ad crushed. The CTA is the last five seconds and *brings the urgency*.

c) Here's a screenshot:

Next Up…

Now that you have the hooks, the meat, and the CTAs, you can put it all together. Let's scale it.

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Scale It

New customers enter your market everyday. And you owe it to them to serve them the highest converting ad possible to get them to buy so you can help them with whatever you do. So, don't get bored repeating the same stuff. *It'll still be the first time they see it.*

In the beginning, you won't know which ads are gonna hit. So, you gotta make a lot of variations. These variations appeal to many different segments of your market. Over time, you'll find that a few ads *wildly* outperform the rest. And when you find those, *double down on what works*. Reuse the same hooks to make *even more winners*. They're the key to unlocking your customer's wallet. This is what allows you to scale.

Final Note

My ad creation process we went through in this playbook is how I *find* winners. Once you have winners, you'll be ready for the next step: Kaleidoscope Ads. It's how I take ads to the moon. But, you can't do those without this. So, start here.

With that being said, let's wrap our time together with a cheat sheet. That way, you can tear it out and put it on your wall or hand it to your team to use on your next ad day.

DO YOU WANT TO SCALE YOUR BUSINESS?

If you double your leads, you double your business. The easiest way to double the amount of leads you get is better advertising. And the easiest way to double advertising, is to make more, better ads. The only thing easier is to make bad ads or no ads at all (most businesses). They're the same people who wonder why they aren't getting more customers, why costs keep going up, and why they can't scale.

If you'd like my help building a system to create ads that sell and scale: **BOOK A 1-ON-1 CALL AT: ACQUISITION.COM/SCALE**. You can also scan the QR code if you hate typing.

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GOATed Ads Playbook Cheat Sheet

Step 1 - Figure out the level of awareness you're targeting. 1) Unaware 2) Problem-Aware 3) Solution-Aware 4) Product-Aware 5) Most Aware.

Step 2 - Write 50 hooks: Either divide the hooks into buckets that hit each level of awareness or focus the majority of your ads broader than your current hooks. To find inspiration: 1) Look at your prior best ads. 2) Look at other top ads for different industries (gold here). 3) Look at your past top short content. 4) Look at others' best short content. 5) Save your favorite ads to review come writing day.

Step 3 - Write 3-5 "meats": Pick a few of the following types.

1) **Demonstration Ads:** Think showcasing your product or service, unboxing, comparison ads, before-and-afters, high production hero ads (think Dollar Shave Club and Old Spice).
2) **Testimonial Ads:** Think user-generated content (UGC), founder direct-to-camera, podcast style, professional testimonials, raw iPhone style testimonials, walk 'n talk rant style, group testimonials (many people in the frame, lifecycle ads (see Marketing Machine Playbook)), man-on-the-street interviews, or celebrity or influencer collabs.
3) **Education Ads:** Think educational/informational, explainer videos, how-to/tutorial, whiteboard explainer, listicle videos, high-performing organic content.
4) **Story Ads:** Think storytelling/narrative, lifestyle, emotional/sentimental, humorous/comedy, brand manifesto, problem-solution.
5) **Faceless Ads:** Think screenshots of customer comments/texts, text only, slide shows, animations, cartoon ads, or visual effect-based ads.

Step 4 - Write 1-3 CTAs: Both show and tell them what to do next. Tell them: 1) What/how to do it. 2) When to do it. 3) What they get for doing it. 4) What happens next (optional). 5) Demonstrate what it looks like and what happens next.

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Step 5 - Try To Find A New Winner: Repeat steps 1-4 to try and find another winner.

Crush it. 'Til next time,

Alex

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